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1. Executive Summary

Kitui Institute of Professionals (KIP) is a growing tertiary college serving students across Kitui County and beyond. With three campuses, twenty-one programmes, and four national examining bodies, the college has reached the scale at which paper registers, spreadsheets, and walk-in enquiries can no longer keep pace with daily operations.

This proposal presents the KIP College System: a complete digital campus platform that unifies the college website, admissions, student services, teaching operations, and administration in one secure online system. The platform is not a concept or a mock-up. It has already been designed, built, tested, and deployed to the internet, and it can be reviewed live today.

3	21	KES 64,000
CAMPUSES IN KITUI COUNTY	PROGRAMMES ACROSS 3 CATEGORIES	ONE-OFF PLATFORM INVESTMENT

The total one-off investment is KES 64,000, covering design and branding, platform development, content and testing, and training with handover. Recurring costs are deliberately modest: KES 10,000 per year for hosting and KES 36,000 per year (KES 3,000 per month) for maintenance and support. Payment follows three clear milestones: 50% on sign-off, 25% on staging delivery, and 25% on go-live.

Because the core platform is complete, the remaining delivery timeline is short: approximately six to eight weeks of branding, content loading, training, and go-live preparation. We invite the college management to explore the live demonstration described in Section 4 and to confirm the content and branding assets required for launch.

2. About Kitui Institute of Professionals

Kitui Institute of Professionals is a tertiary college headquartered in Kitui Town, Kenya. The college delivers accessible, career-focused training through three campuses, each serving a distinct community of learners. Its academic portfolio spans twenty-one programmes organised into three categories: technical, business, and KASNEB professional courses.

Campuses

Campus	Location
Main Campus	100 metres from Wikililye, Mulango Road, Kitui

Campus	Location
Town Campus	Muli Mall Building, Kitui Central Business District
Mwingi Campus	Sunrise Building, Mwingi Town

Table 1 — KIP campus locations.

Academic portfolio

The breadth of the portfolio is central to this proposal. Technical courses cover information and communication technology, engineering trades, and hairdressing and beauty therapy. Business courses prepare students for commercial and administrative careers. KASNEB professional courses, including CPA, CAMS, and ATD, are examined by KASNEB, while other programmes are examined by KNEC, NITA, and TVET-CDACC.

Category	Representative programmes	Examining bodies
Technical	ICT, engineering, hairdressing and beauty therapy, and related trades	KNEC, NITA, TVET-CDACC
Business	Business management and commercial studies	KNEC, TVET-CDACC
KASNEB professional	CPA, CAMS, ATD and other professional qualifications	KASNEB

Table 2 — Programme categories and examining bodies.

A multi-campus college with this examination mix needs one dependable system of record: a single place where applications become enrolments, fees are tracked to the shilling, results follow a controlled publication workflow, and every campus reads the same timetable. That is precisely the role of the KIP College System.

3. The Proposed Solution

The KIP College System is one integrated platform with six cooperating modules. Every user reaches the system through a single web address, signs in securely, and sees only the functions appropriate to their role. The table below summarises the platform at a glance.

Module	What it does	Primary users
Public website	College news and announcements, programme catalogue with fees, campus and gallery pages, frequently asked questions, and contact forms. Managed without a developer through the built-in content tools.	Prospective students, parents, the public

Module	What it does	Primary users
Online admissions	Guided application wizard that validates every field, issues a unique reference number in the KIP/APP/YYYY/XXXXX format, blocks duplicates, and lands completed applications straight in the administrative inbox.	Applicants, admissions staff
Student portal	Personal dashboard with fee statements and payment history, published results, class timetable, learning materials, announcements, and an AI study assistant for revision questions.	Students
Lecturer workspace	Class rosters per teaching unit, marks entry with a draft-to-publish workflow, and a lecturer view of the master timetable.	Lecturers
Admin console	Students and applications management, courses and course units, fees and payments, results moderation and publication, news and announcements publishing, and timetable administration with exports and reports.	Registrar, accounts, management
AI study assistant	A guided study companion inside the student portal that answers revision questions and points students to the right learning materials.	Students

Table 3 — Platform modules at a glance.

How the modules work together

The platform follows the natural life cycle of a student. An applicant completes the online application form and receives a reference number immediately. Admissions staff review the application in the admin console and, once accepted, the applicant becomes a student record with fees, course units, and a timetable. Lecturers record marks as drafts and publish them only after moderation, at which point results appear in the student portal. Throughout the cycle, the accounts office sees balances and payments in real time, and management publishes news that appears instantly on the public website.

This single flow eliminates the fragmentation that normally exists between a website, a spreadsheet, and a filing cabinet. Information is entered once, validated at the point of entry, and reused everywhere it is needed.

4. See It Live — Working Demonstration

The platform is deployed and running on the internet right now. Management can explore every module before any commitment is made, using the demo address and the demo accounts below.

https://kip-college-system.vercel.app

Open this address in any browser — desktop or mobile. No installation required.

The demo runs on Vercel with a persistent PostgreSQL database (Prisma Postgres), so the data you enter during exploration is saved and visible across visits. All records on the demo site are demonstration data and will be replaced with official college records at go-live.

Demo accounts

Role	Email address	Password
Administrator	admin@kipskitui.com	Admin@123
Lecturer	lecturer@kipskitui.com	Lecturer@123
Student	student@kipskitui.com	Student@123

Table 4 — Demo login credentials for the live system.

Suggested things to try

- **As an administrator:** open the applications inbox and review a submitted application, record a fee payment, and publish a news announcement that appears instantly on the public website.
- **As a lecturer:** open a class roster, enter marks and save them as a draft, then publish the results so they become visible to students.
- **As a student:** review the fee statement and payment history, check the class timetable, view published results, and ask the AI study assistant a revision question.
- **As a member of the public:** browse the programme catalogue, then submit a demonstration application and watch the system issue a KIP/APP reference number on the confirmation screen.

While exploring, note the reference-number format on applications, the draft-to-publish discipline on results, and the role-based menus: each account sees a workspace tailored to its responsibilities and nothing else.

5. Technology and Security

The platform is built on a modern, well-supported technology stack. These choices keep the system fast, secure, and inexpensive to operate, and they ensure that any competent developer can maintain it in the future without being locked into obscure tools.

Layer	Technology	Why it matters
Application framework	Next.js 16	The industry-standard React framework; fast page loads and a first-class deployment pipeline.
Language	TypeScript	Strict typing catches errors before release and keeps the codebase maintainable as the college grows.
Interface	Tailwind CSS with shadcn/ui	A polished, consistent, mobile-friendly interface that adapts to phones, tablets, and desktops.
Database	PostgreSQL via Prisma Postgres	A reliable relational database with automatic provisioning; fee and results arithmetic is computed in integer cents to avoid rounding errors.
Hosting	Vercel	Global content delivery, HTTPS by default, and automatic deployments with no servers for the college to own or maintain.

Table 5 — Technology stack.

Security by design

The system handles personal data and financial records, so security is built into the application itself rather than bolted on afterwards.

- **Role-based access control:** administrator, lecturer, and student capabilities are strictly separated; every sensitive endpoint verifies the signed-in role before responding.
- **Rate limiting:** login attempts, password changes, application submissions, and contact forms are throttled to blunt automated attacks and form abuse.
- **Audit trail:** sign-ins, password changes, application decisions, and results publication are recorded with a timestamp so sensitive actions are traceable to an account.
- **Secure sessions:** hardened, signed session cookies with automatic expiry, plus origin checks on authenticated requests.
- **Validated inputs:** every form and API request is validated on the server before it touches the database.
- **Controlled results workflow:** marks remain drafts until deliberately published, protecting students from accidental or premature releases.

6. Investment

The one-off investment covers everything required to take the platform from the working demonstration to a branded, content-complete production system in the college's own name. The breakdown is deliberately transparent so that management can see exactly what each shilling buys.

Total one-off investment: KES 64,000

Inclusive of design, development, content, testing, deployment, and training.

Component	Scope of work	Amount (KES)
Design and branding	College identity applied across the platform: colours, typography, imagery treatment, and print-ready document styling.	15,000
Platform development	Completion and refinement of all six modules, integrations, performance tuning, and production hardening.	22,000
Content, testing and deployment	Loading of programmes, fees, campuses, staff and student records; end-to-end testing; go-live deployment.	18,000
Training and handover	Hands-on training for administrators, lecturers, and students, plus documentation and administrative handover.	9,000
Total one-off investment	**Everything required for go-live**	**64,000**

Table 6 — One-off investment breakdown.

Note: fee figures are indicative and remain subject to final confirmation by the college owner.

Payment milestones

Milestone	Trigger event	Share	Amount (KES)
First payment	Proposal sign-off and project initiation	50%	32,000
Second payment	Delivery of the staging site with college content loaded	25%	16,000
Final payment	Go-live of the production system	25%	16,000
Total	**Full one-off investment**	**100%**	**64,000**

Table 7 — Payment milestone schedule.

The milestone structure means the college only pays the second and third instalments after seeing staged, working results. Recurring hosting and support costs are presented separately in Section 8.

7. Delivery Timeline

Because the core platform is already built and running, the delivery calendar focuses on making it yours: branding, content, people, and launch. The schedule below spans approximately six to eight weeks from sign-off, with each phase producing a visible, verifiable output.

Phase	Weeks	Focus and key activities
1. Discovery and branding	Week 1	Confirm colours, logo usage, and identity; agree the content checklist; collect programme and fee data from the registrar and accounts office.
2. Content and data loading	Weeks 2–3	Load all twenty-one programmes, fee structures, campus details, staff accounts, and the initial news and gallery content.
3. Staging review	Weeks 3–4	Management walks through the fully populated staging site; feedback is collected, prioritised, and implemented.
4. Training and handover	Weeks 4–5	Role-based training for administrators, lecturers, and student representatives; delivery of documentation and admin credentials.
5. Go-live	Week 6	Connect the college domain, switch on production, seed official student and staff records, and announce the launch.
6. Post-launch support	Weeks 6–8	On-call assistance during the first weeks of real use, fixes, and tuning based on live feedback from staff and students.

Table 8 — Delivery phases from sign-off to steady-state operation.

The critical path is content availability: the faster official programme, fee, and staff data can be confirmed, the earlier the college can go live. No phase requires the college to procure hardware or software; everything runs on managed cloud infrastructure.

8. Hosting, Support and Maintenance

Beyond the one-off investment, operating the platform involves two predictable recurring costs. Together they keep the system online, current, and supported, and they are structured so the college always knows its annual commitment in advance.

Item	Frequency	Cost
Hosting (Vercel and managed PostgreSQL)	Per year	KES 10,000
Maintenance and support	Per year — KES 3,000 per month	KES 36,000
Total recurring	**Annual commitment**	**KES 46,000**

Table 9 — Recurring costs.

What the recurring costs cover

- Continued hosting on Vercel with global content delivery, HTTPS, and automatic database provisioning and backups.
- Technical support for staff questions and incident response during business hours.
- Software updates, security patches, and compatibility maintenance for the platform and its dependencies.
- Minor content and feature adjustments as the college's needs evolve, within the monthly support allowance.

There are no per-student charges and no hidden licence fees: the platform grows with the college at a flat, budgetable rate.

9. Next Steps and Contacts

The distance between today and a live, branded KIP College System is short and mostly administrative. We recommend the following sequence:

- **1. Explore the live demo.** Visit https://kip-college-system.vercel.app and sign in with the three demo accounts in Section 4.
- **2. Confirm branding assets.** Provide the logo files, preferred colours, and any photography guidelines for application across the platform.
- **3. Nominate a content owner.** Identify the staff member who will confirm programme details, fees, campus information, and staff accounts.
- **4. Sign off and initiate.** Execute the agreement and the first milestone payment (KES 32,000) to open the delivery calendar.
- **5. Review staging and go live.** Walk through the staged system with your content loaded, then launch on the college's own domain.

> **Contacts.** Email: info@kipskitui.com · Telephone: +254 703 710 879 (to be verified by owner) · Live demo: https://kip-college-system.vercel.app

Note: telephone numbers and fee figures quoted in this proposal are pending final verification by the college owner and will be confirmed before sign-off.

We thank the management of Kitui Institute of Professionals for the opportunity to present this proposal, and we look forward to handing over the keys to a platform that will serve the college's students and staff for years to come.